

```

for (var i = 0; i < list.length; i++) {
    var item = 'obj' + list[i];
    my_list.push( function() {console.log(item)} );
}
return my_list;
}

function testMyList() {
    var result_list = constructList([1,2,3]);
    for (var j = 0; j < result_list.length; j++) {
        result_list[j]();
    }
}
testMyList();

```

Can you guess what the output would be? The output is “obj3 ” repeated thrice. Can you explain why this is so? This is because all the three inner functions stored in ‘result_list’ share the same closure. At the end of executing ‘ConstructList’, the value of ‘i’ is 3 in the closure created, and hence list[i] is 3. Therefore testMyList outputs ‘obj3’ thrice. We will explore loops and closures further in next month’s column.

My ‘must-read book’ for this month

This month’s ‘must-read’ book suggestion comes from our reader Praveen Kumar. He suggests the book ‘JavaScript, the Definitive Guide’ by David Flanagan.

According to Praveen, “This is a good book for any beginner who wants to get a deep understanding of JavaScript. Though it is verbose, it highlights all major language features, including browser DOM interaction, etc. Use this in conjunction with Doug Crockford’s book ‘JavaScript—the Good Parts’.” Thank you, Praveen, for your recommendation.

If you have a favourite programming book or article that you think is a must-read for every programmer, please do send me a note with the book’s name, and a short write-up on why you think it is useful, so I can mention it in the column. This would help many readers who want to improve their coding skills.

If you have any favourite programming puzzles that you would like to discuss on this forum, please send them to me, along with your solutions and feedback, at sandyasm_at_yahoo_DOT_com. Till we meet again next month, happy programming and here’s wishing you the very best! 

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The author is an expert in systems software, and is currently working as a researcher in IBM India Research Labs. Her interests include compilers, multi-core technologies and software development tools. If you are preparing for systems software interviews, you may find it useful to visit Sandya’s LinkedIn group ‘Computer Science Interview Training India’ at <http://www.linkedin.com/groups?home=&gid=2339182>.



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